4 copies furnished to the Private Secretary (1 for Sir R. Makins, 3 for the Secretary of State). DAR Later 25/12

United Kingdom Liaison Mission in Japan,

TOKYO.

127

SECRET
(4951/40/51)

17th December, 1951.

FJ 10310/47

F.

Dear Ronald,

I am slightly puzzled about Dulles on this occasion. He talks like he always did, and it is not a new technique for him to show his claws somewhat at the outset only to withdraw them out of sight in the hope that the display will have the desired effect. (I refer to his remark that the Americans have more cards than we and can therefore compel the Japanese to sign a treaty with Chiang Kai-shek). But he showed little tendency on this occasion to meet our point of view to any degree, and since he knew at an early stage that I had no authority to agree to anything, he can hardly have supposed that by being firm he could induce a change of front through me, the more so as I gave him no encouragement at all to suppose that H.M. Government were likely to change their minds.

2. Dulles personally, of course, has everything at stake on this issue. Only Oliver Franks can say whether Dulles' account of the political difficulties which confront him are as formidable as he made out. But as it is probable that Americans generally have quite failed to appreciate the extent to which the Japanese have changed (or rather reverted to type) since the Treaty was signed, one can easily imagine that many politicians would be outraged to think that Japan may fail to respond instantly to public cracks of the whip. Though to the world at large it is inconceivable that the Senate should commit the major folly of not ratifying the treaty which the United States initiated and sponsored, I suppose almost anything is possible in an election year. Dulles himself said it was a bad time to be undertaking the ratification of a treaty and hinted at endless delays. He must himself be aware, however, that the longer ratification is delayed the more tempers are likely to rise as the election draws near.

3. We have for some time suspected that the Pentagon may not be very keen on early ratification of the treaty, partly because of the Korean war and

partly/

R. H. Scott, Esq., C.M.G., C.B.E.,

Foreign Office.

Reference:-
FO 371/92605
PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION

partly because of the vested interests here which want to go on if possible for ever in the same way. Dulles said that many in the Pentagon had not wanted the treaty at all, and that Japan's intransigence is making them more vocal.

4. When we consider the Japanese angle we must remember that Yoshida never liked our leaving it to Japan to decide the China issue. What he wanted was to be told to take a line so he could blame us if things went wrong. Now he has retreated to a safer line which is that Japan cannot do anything because we and the American's don't agree. This is consistent with his technique which is that of a wriggler, but it also provides an answer both to those of his countrymen who feel it is unwise to offend the United States because of the aid she can give and those who are strongly opposed to jeopardising the future of Japan's relations with China. Though the temper of the Japanese people has changed since the Treaty was signed, they are not yet ready to take an independent line of their own.

5. As far as we are concerned, though the Americans are behaving very badly over this, I think we must be careful not to put the Japanese in the position of being able to blame us if the United States turns sour and either refuses to help Japan or proves very unaccommodating. For though Yoshida is well disposed towards us, if we were to stimulate Japanese resistance to signing a treaty with Chiang Kai-shek, and Japan were to get into trouble with the United States, he would not hesitate to lay it at our door. As it is, his present attitude is likely to increase American irritation with us. Dulles mentioned to me that he hoped Mr. Churchill's visit to Washington would enable the United Kingdom and the United States to reach agreement on their China policy. In the context of what he was saying he could only have meant that we should agree to toe the line and alter our own policy.

6. In fact the Americans are forcing the pace for reasons of internal political expediency. I gave Dulles my views about Chiang Kai-shek as a runner in the China Stakes, and both he and Sebald, who was present, laughed very heartily, and agreed that he would never stage a come-back in China. Yet they can see no inconsistency in forcing Japan to make a treaty with him.

7/

Reference:-
FO 371/92605
PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION

7. As you know, I have always held the view that if the United States persist and the Japanese succumb there is really nothing we can do about it. The United States will once again weaken their own influence in Asia and inspire an even deeper distrust of their policy than already prevails there. And to the extent that we fail to stop them from doing something both wrong and foolish, our own prestige will suffer both with the Commonwealth, in Asia and with Japan. But I imagine that as usual we shall have to tread warily in a Presidential election year. Whether that debars us from saying what we think, even behind the scenes, I do not know.

8. I am sending a copy of this letter to Oliver Franks.

Yours ever.

Bill Strang.

P.S. Since I drafted the above I have attended a lunch given by the French Ambassador for Dulles and the Senators, and attended by Heads of Missions and leading Japanese., In reply to the host, Dulles said that when he arrived he said he was not here to negotiate anything. It appeared that some people did not accept this, and every morning he read the press with great interest to discover what he had been doing the day before. He passed the time of day with me after lunch in the friendliest possible manner, and gave not a clue whether he has succeeded or failed in his object. He is dining with me tonight, but the bag will have gone by then.

Reference:
FO 371/92605
PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
COPYRIGHT - NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION